▼ GLASSHOUSE



THE COAST IS NOT CLEAR

"English is just a language, not a measure of knowledge," Telangana chief minister **Revanth Reddy** has said often, swatting away jibes over his fluency. Fair enough, but what about basic general knowledge, the Opposition is now asking. At a March 28 event in Hyderabad, where he laid the foundation for a new Omkareshwara temple (seen as the launch of his ambitious Musi riverfront redevelopment), Reddy claimed that "of India's 29 states, only Telangana lacks a seashore". The blooper was instantly picked up by the Opposition (20 states in India are landlocked), with Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) leader K.T. Rama Rao's team amplifying it with a video montage of his past slips. One 'flashback' from October 2024 had Reddy declaring that Telangana "has seas on three sides". With Reddy also holding the education portfolio, BRS leaders are now warning all students to fact-check what their CM is saying.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

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▼ CHAI PE CHARCHA

PM TAKES A TEA BREAK

On the morning of April 1, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** was getting ready to leave the Monohari Tea Estate in Dibrugarh, where his election entourage had halted for the night, when he spotted a few estate workers heading for work and expressed a wish to meet them. The garden's owner, Rajen Lohiya, promptly arranged a few Hindi-speaking workers. The PM spent a good 45 minutes interacting with them before it was time to leave. A hectic day lay ahead; there was his scheduled airport departure and rallies in Assam's Gogamukh and Behali. Of course, when pictures of the visit flooded social media, the Opposition derided them as a 'photo-op' to woo the tea garden voters. But the PM's team says the meeting wasn't planned. The workers were en route to the gardens, and the PM didn't mind a chat.